1. What does being a software engineer or building a product mean to you?
-> Engineers are those people who study the existing problem and figure out a way to solve that problem with existing tools or build new tools for the problem.

Someone who has the skill to understand and break down the problem into smaller, solvable chunks.

Someone needed to do math; they built a computer. That's an engineer.

Building a product is simply a way to solve that problem.

We aim to solve some problems, and by that we just happen to build products as solution for that problem.

A product is simply an effect of a problem.
Not the cause itself and infact engineering is just a mindset.

2. Which factor do you believe contributes most to building a sustainable product: a great engineering team and strong technical decisions, clear product direction, or faster implementation and rapid iteration? While all are important, we want to understand your perspective. Please choose the one you personally value most and explain why?

-> While a great team and rapid iteration do impact on the success of a product.
To me, a clear product direction comes foremost.
All of our technical and non-technical decisions are byproducts of the product direction.
If we don't know what we are building and why, it will impact the great team and other decisions.
We will be like a crow in a fog.

As long as the direction is clear, we can confidently start building a product in that direction as well as we can confidently iterate and refactor.

3. Share three principles you live by as a developer. These can be related to how you approach coding, how you think about building products, managing deadlines, working with teams, or anything else that reflects your mindset.
-> Code is just a tool we use, and engineering is just a mindset.
But if I had to pick three core values as a dev:

a. Clarity over cleverness
   There are multiple way we can solve the same problem.
   Some may takes less LOC while other takes more LOC.
   Nevertheless, it's always better to have more LOC if it means I will understand the code in future. As well as my other team mates should understand my code.
   Doing so we can communicate and collaborate better.

Better to have a variable name like “all_the_users_above_x” than “users”.

b. Ownership
   Each line of code and product we write are our creation.
   It’s a must to take ownership of products like they are our own child, which infact they are.
   Code isn’t disposable, it’s the product itself. Not a throwaway script.

c. Empathy driven development
   Product exist for end users.
   Code exists for us, developers.
   Both side are trying to solve a problem in some way.

   If we dn’t treat ourself, our code and our team mates with understanding and empathy, the product might not be what we want it to be.

   Write code we devs understand. For we will have to maintain it. Show love and compassion usig docs, comments, clean code and so on.

4. Describe your ideal workflow as a developer. Tell us about the tools and technologies you prefer: your use of LLMs, code assistants, browser setup, debugging tools, tech stack, or any other parts of your environment. What should we know about you from the way you work and the tools you choose?
-> My ideal workflow is centered around speed with clarity.
Editor and coding setup:
I work primarily with Nvim with linting and formatter configured.
Depending on the stack i am using they tends to change here and there.

I use docker for local development.

Debugging Tools
For backend i use nodejs built in debugger along with logger.
For frontend, I use browser debugger and dev tools.

Use of LLMS and code assistants
While I am not a 10x engineer with LLM, but I use them like a dictionary.
I use them to review concepts and get an insight on new topic.

I dn’t vibe code with them, but rather I use them like a junior assistant who has data but can’t process. While I can process but have no data.

5. Tell us about the project you're most proud of. Describe the major challenges you faced, what you learned, and bring us into the journey of building and shaping this project. This doesn't have to be something you only coded - it could also be about the impact you made, the initiative you took, or how you contributed. If you did code it and want to share a GitHub link or any reference, we'd love that.

-> Each project, or I would say, each feature is challenging in one way or another.
Be it domain level problem or stack level problem, as a developer every step forward seems challenging.

But If i had to pick the project i am most product of I would say it's 'sim management system'

I worked on this project during my early days of programming.

Basically, it's a product to let user buy SIM online and admin manages those sells.

I had to work alone with NextJS and the form was quite huge with multiple dynamic segments.

I felt lazy to manage and maintaining 50+ input fields with stepper form as that amount of code will tremendously increat LOC and it will be headace to debug them.

So I made a form builder, which takes an array of object which describes the relation between fields if there'are any and input field metadata.

With that in place, I just had to look into the form fields schema for any issue or if I wanted to add new field, just add an object. No need to worry about how it's gonna render.

To this date, this is my proudest feature i have wrote because it literally shaped the way I look into code. And though i have worked with more complex features, this one seems to be always in my heart.